

IRONTHREAD
COMICS



ISSUE

1

\$4.99 US

SHIMIZU
DÍAZ
PARK

SOME THREADS BIND. OTHERS SET YOU FREE.

RENN

ESCAPEMENT

糸が導く、運命を超えて。



THE SPOOL AWAITS.

THE ESCAPEMENT.
HEART OF THE CLOCK.
WOUND BY KINGS.
KEPT BY NO ONE.



R...RENN?
YOU SURE
YOU SHOULD
BE THE ONE
UP THERE?



SOMEONE'S
GOTTA DO IT.
MIGHT AS WELL
BE ME.

BESIDES...
I'M THE ONLY
ONE DUMB
ENOUGH.



THIS ISN'T
DUMB.

IT'S
SUICIDE.

WHICH IS
EXACTLY WHY
I WON'T STOP
YOU.



CENTURIES OF TENSION.
WOUND INTO THREAD.
THREAD INTO GLASS.
GLASS INTO HISTORY.

ONE WRONG MOVE,
AND IT UNWINDS.
EVERYTHING.



JUST NEED A WAY
TO HOLD IT.
JUST NEED A WAY
TO LET GO.

JUST NEED TO
NOT THINK ABOUT
ANYTHING ELSE.

I...I CAN
CALCULATE
THE TENSION
CURVE...

IF YOU
TELL ME HOW
MUCH SLACK
YOU NEED...

I-I'LL DO
MY BEST.
I PROMISE.



THAT'S WHY
YOU'RE HERE,
BIX.

COUNT.
KEEP COUNT.
KEEP ME
ALIVE.



YEAH?

AND I'LL
KEEP THE
ANCHORS
STEADY.

UNTIL YOU
REMEMBER
WHO YOU'RE
DOING THIS
FOR.

UNDERSTOOD?



UNDERSTOOD.
LET'S GET TO
WORK.



TENSION SPIKING.
ANCHOR HOLDING.
MARGIN: 0.7%

... AND FALLING.

KRRRNNN

IT'S
OVERLOADING!
ONE MORE SPIKE
AND THE WHOLE
THING RIPS
—INCLUDING ME!

JUST CUT IT.
SEVER THE LINE.
END THE TENSION.
MAKE IT STOP.

MAKE IT STOP!

SHK!

WAIT.
NO.
NOT FEAR.
CHOICE.

BREATHE.
HOLD.
TRUST THE PLAN.
NOT THE PANIC.

I DON'T CUT
THE LINE.
I RIDE IT.

RENN AND THE SPOOL

CHAPTER 7:
THE FIRST TOUCH

THE KNOTMASTER
SAW IT AS A LIVING
THING.

TAUGHT ME TO
LISTEN BEFORE
I REACH.

THE SPOOL.
OLDER THAN THE
TOWERS.
OLDER THAN
MY PEOPLE.

A KNOT BOUND
BEFORE MEMORY--
HOLDING STORIES
THAT SHOULD
HAVE FADED.



BREATHE.
FOCUS.
LET THE
THREADS
SPEAK.



HIS LESSONS.
HIS PATIENCE.
HIS TRUST.

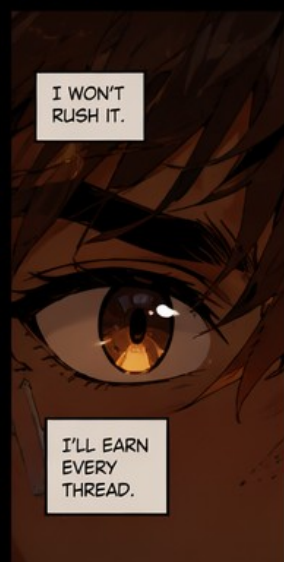


I TRACE.
NOT TO TAKE.
BUT TO
UNDERSTAND.



FAINT.
BUT IT
RESPONDS.
DORMANT
LIGHT.

WAITING.



I WON'T
RUSH IT.

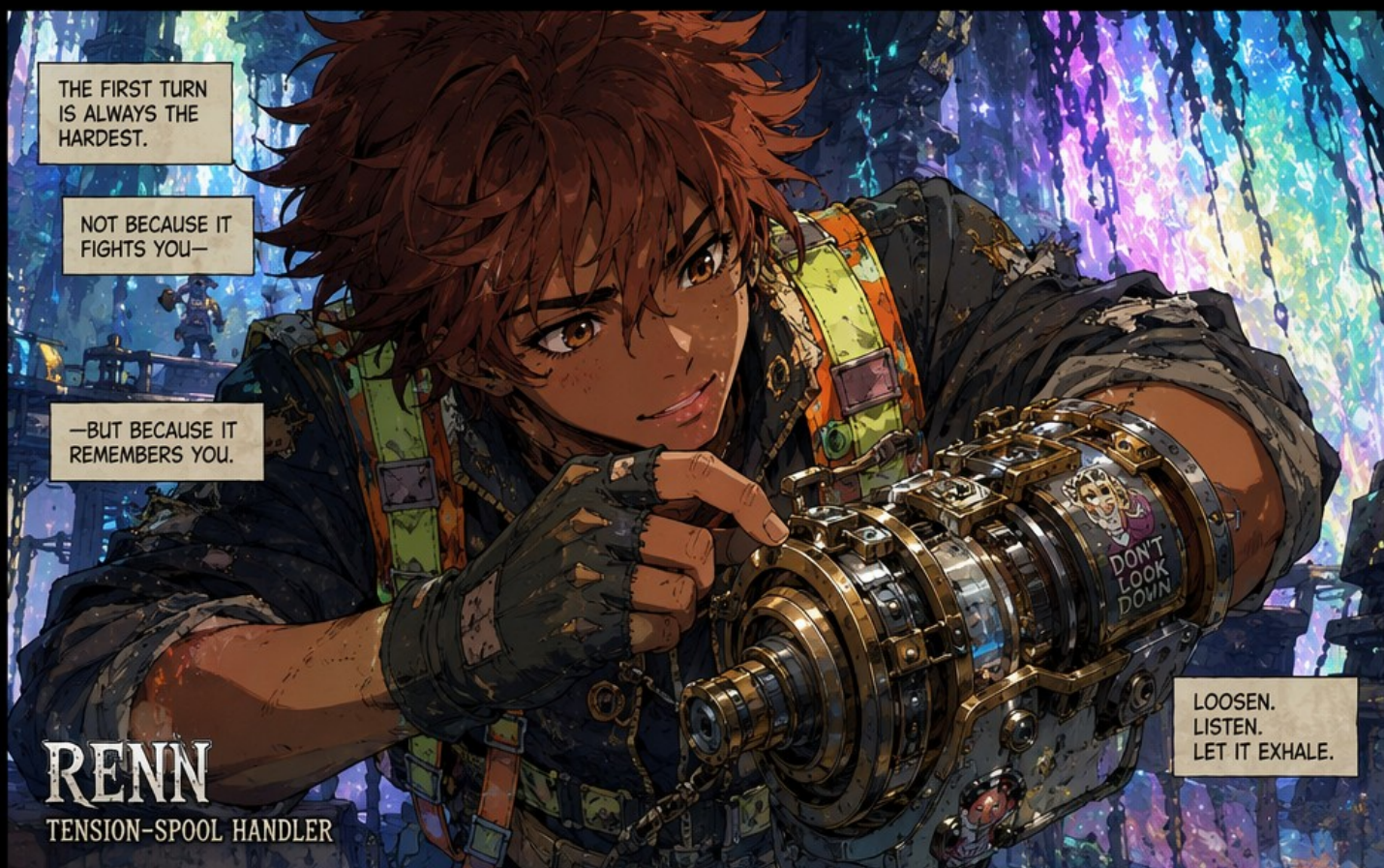
I'LL EARN
EVERY
THREAD.



LET'S SEE
WHAT YOU'VE
BEEN HOLDING,
OLD FRIEND.



HMM
MMMM



THE FIRST TURN
IS ALWAYS THE
HARDEST.

NOT BECAUSE IT
FIGHTS YOU—

—BUT BECAUSE IT
REMEMBERS YOU.

RENN

TENSION-SPOOL HANDLER

LOOSEN.
LISTEN.
LET IT EXHALE.



FLARE

ONE BREATH OF
BLUE.



THE SPOOL
STIRS.

THE RIVER
RECOGNIZES
ITS PULL.

BY THE
ANCHOR...

I'VE NEVER
SEEN THE FIRST
TURN BEFORE.

IT'S
BEAUTIFUL...

"TENSION ISN'T
THE ENEMY.

*FORGETTING
THE CURRENT IS."*

**ANCHORITE
RELICS** 

CHAPTER 7: FIRST TURN

RENN & THE ESCAPEMENT

The Escapement
was never meant
to be opened.

Every knot is
a lock.
Every lock,
a forgetting.



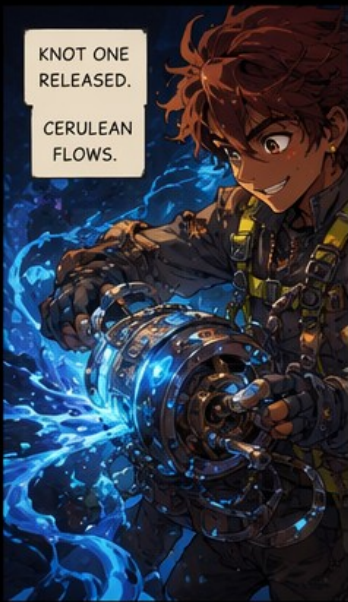
But I'm not
here to forget.

I'm here to
remember
what they
tried to
seal away.



KNOT ONE
RELEASED.

CERULEAN
FLOWS.



KNOT TWO
UNTIED.

GOLD
IGNITES.



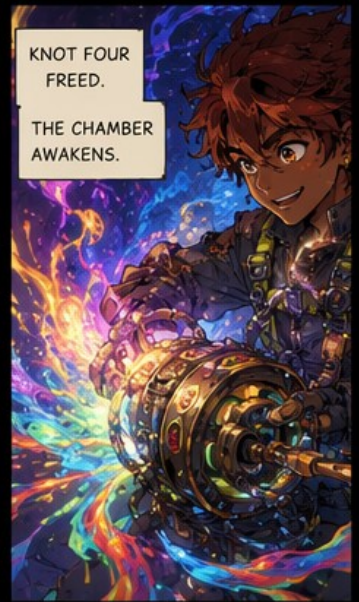
KNOT THREE
LOOSENED.

VIOLET
BLOOMS.



KNOT FOUR
FREED.

THE CHAMBER
AWAKENS.



THE ESCAPEMENT
DOESN'T JUST
OPEN—

IT REMEMBERS.



COLOR.
MOVEMENT.
MEANING.

ALL RETURN.

THIS ISN'T
JUST LIGHT.

IT'S
EVERYTHING
THE WORLD
FORGOT
IT COULD BE.



ONE KNOT
AT A TIME.

I'LL
UNTANGLE
THE PAST—

AND RE-WEAVE
SOMETHING
BRIGHTER.



LET'S
KEEP
GOING.





THE ESCAPEMENT
DOESN'T CARE WHO
YOU WERE.

IT CARES WHO
KEEPS IT
MOVING.

GROOONK

C'MON...
C'MON...
JUST A LITTLE
MORE—!

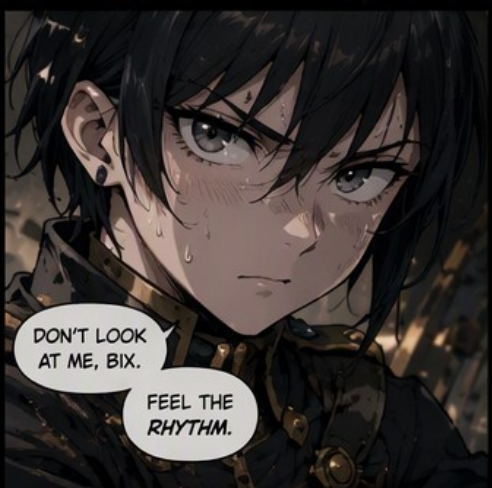
TIK
TAK
TIK
TAK



EVERY SECOND
WE HOLD...

...IS A SECOND
RENN GETS TO
FINISH.

SHUDDDDER



DON'T LOOK
AT ME, BIX.

FEEL THE
RHYTHM.



R-RIGHT...
THE THIRD
CLICK IS
LONGER...

TIK...
TAK...



GOOD.

NOW MAKE
IT SING.



WE DON'T
STOP THE
ESCAPEMENT.

WE JUST
REFUSE TO LET
IT BREAK US.

THE ESCAPEMENT'S
KINETIC FEEDBACK
BEGINS TO REACH A
SCREAMING PEAK.

COLOSSAL GEARS
SPINNING AT A
TERRIFYING,
BLURRING VELOCITY.

BRASS FITTINGS
GROANING AND
STRAINING TOWARD
THE EDGE OF
MECHANICAL
SELF-DESTRUCTION.

GNR2RRMMMMMM

KREEEEEEEE—!

THE SPOOL HOLDS.
BUT THE ESCAPEMENT
WANTS MORE.
IT WANTS **EVERYTHING.**

RENN.
SIXTEEN.
LEANS, WIRY BUILD.
QUICK EYES.
MISCHIEF. WARMTH.
FOCUS.
NO PANIC.

TENSION-GAUNTLET
SPOOL.
SCARED. DENTED.
STICKERED.
TRUSTED.

HIS GRIP IS GENTLE.
HIS WILL IS STEADY.
HE LISTENS.
HE ADAPTS.
HE HOLDS.

THE ESCAPEMENT
SCREAMS.
RENN BREATHES.
IN. OUT.
IN. OUT.
AGAIN.
**AND AGAIN.
AND AGAIN.**

THE MACHINE
WANTS TO
BREAK FREE.
RENN IS THE ONLY
THING BETWEEN
POWER...

**KLANG!
KLANG!
KLANG!**

...AND
CATASTROPHE.



THE TOWER
DOESN'T SLEEP.

IT SCREAMS.

KRRRNNNNCHH

RENN.

AGE: SIXTEEN
TENSION-RUNNER
SPOOL-CLIMBER

RESTORED HAND.
REBUILT LIFE.

ONE THREAD
AT A TIME.



EVERYTHING
KNOWS THIS
MOMENT.
THE MACHINES.
THE HEIGHT.
EVEN THE THREAD.

ESPECIALLY
THE THREAD.

ONE CHOICE.
ONE BREATH.



HIS HAND
HOVERS.
NOT FROM
DOUBT.

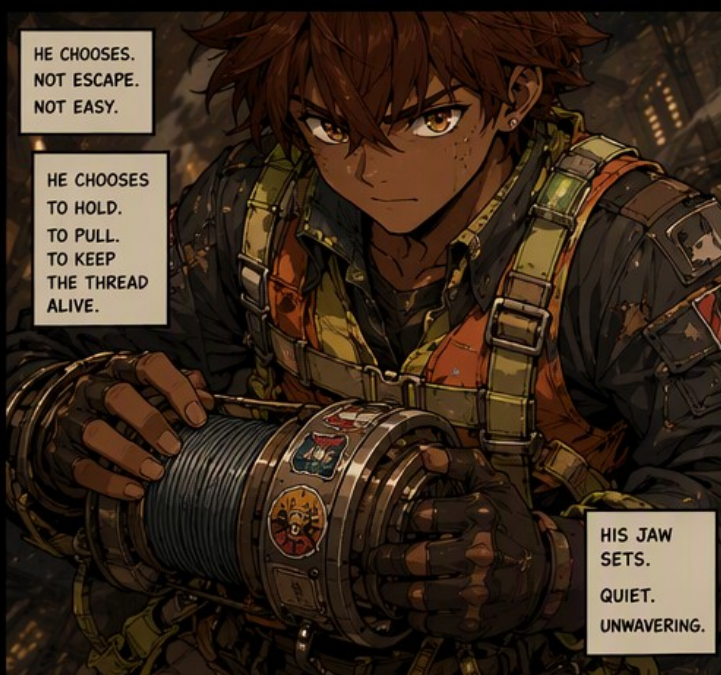
FROM RESPECT.
FOR WHAT
COULD END
EVERYTHING.



THE PITCH
RISES.
THE WORLD
NARROWS.

WHRRRRRR

AND THEN—



HE CHOOSES.
NOT ESCAPE.
NOT EASY.

HE CHOOSES
TO HOLD.
TO PULL.
TO KEEP
THE THREAD
ALIVE.

HIS JAW
SETS.
QUIET.
UNWAVERING.



BECAUSE
SOMEONE
HAS TO BE
THE LINE
BETWEEN
FALLING...

...AND
HOLDING
ON.

A MASSIVE BRASS
SUPPORT BEAM—
FINAL ANCHOR IN
A CHAMBER THAT
SHOULD HAVE BEEN
EMPTY HOURS AGO.

SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.
ANCHORITE
VANGUARD CADET.
DISCIPLINE CUT
SHARPER THAN
HER BLADE.

BIX.
FOURTEEN.
GEAR-TINKER.
BRILLIANT. NERVOUS.
HE BREAKS BEFORE
HIS MACHINES DO.

I-I DON'T
THINK THAT'S
SUPPOSED TO
MOVE—!

BIX!

SHOVE!

WHOA!

KRAAAA!!!

POSITION
THREE.
NOW.

R-RIGHT!

PRESSURE
SPIKING!
VENT
CALIBRATION—

FOCUS, RENN.
THE ENGINE
DOESN'T CARE
WHO SURVIVES.



TENSION
KNOT: LAST
OF THE
ANCESTOR SPOOL

THE LAST
KNOT.

EVERYTHING
HAS LED
TO THIS.



SLOWER NOW.

EVERY RELEASE
TEARS THROUGH
CENTURIES OF
TENSION.

KRRR-KK--

DON'T RUSH.
DON'T SNAP.



NNNGH--

CHRRRKKKK--!



LIGHT
REMEMBERS.



EACH KNOT
UNDONE...

...A FLOOD
OF WHAT
WAS LOST.



THE CHAMBER
BREATHES
AGAIN.



NOT JUST
LIGHT.

LIFE.



THIS PLACE
WAS NEVER
BROKEN.

IT WAS JUST
HOLDING ITS
BREATH.

TO BE CONTINUED...



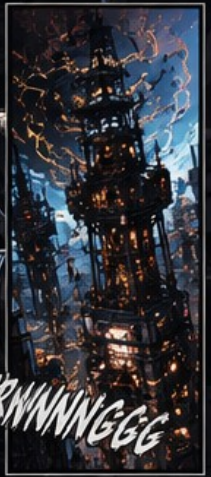
THE TOWER'S LAST ANCHOR.
ONE KNOT LEFT.

ALL THAT HOLDS
THE CITY TOGETHER
...IS ABOUT TO BE ME.

KKK
KKK
KKK

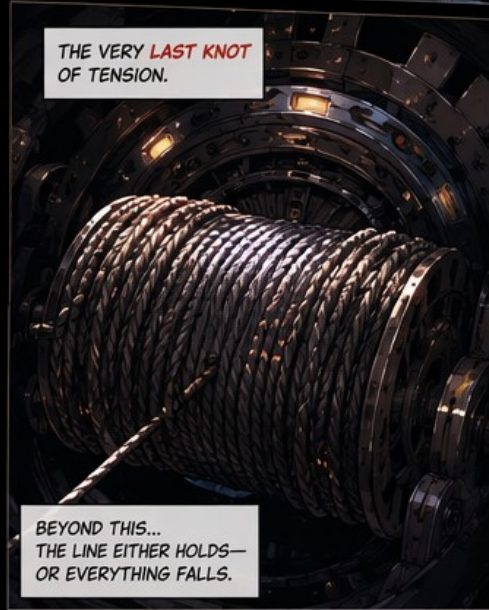
KRRRRNNNNNGGGG

KRRRRNNNNNGGGG



SO CLOSE
I CAN FEEL IT.

JUST ONE
MORE TURN...



THE VERY **LAST KNOT**
OF TENSION.

BEYOND THIS...
THE LINE EITHER HOLDS—
OR EVERYTHING FALLS.



HANDS SHAKING...

HUFF

HUFF

NOT FROM FEAR.



BREATHE IN.

ALL THE NOISE.
ALL THE WEIGHT.
ALL THE LIVES.

BREATHE OUT.

JUST ME.
THE LINE.
AND THE TURN.



ALRIGHT...

LET'S
FINISH THIS.

CHAK



FOR EVERYONE
WHO CAN'T HOLD IT...

...I WILL.



NOW.

TENSION-GAUNTLET,
FINAL KNOT.

RELEASE.

CREATIVITY
ISN'T
NEAT

CHK

SHREEEEEEEE

THE ESCAPEMENT'S
SHRIEK SOFTENS...

...INTO A HUM.

HUMMMMMMMMM

THEN--
EVERYTHING.

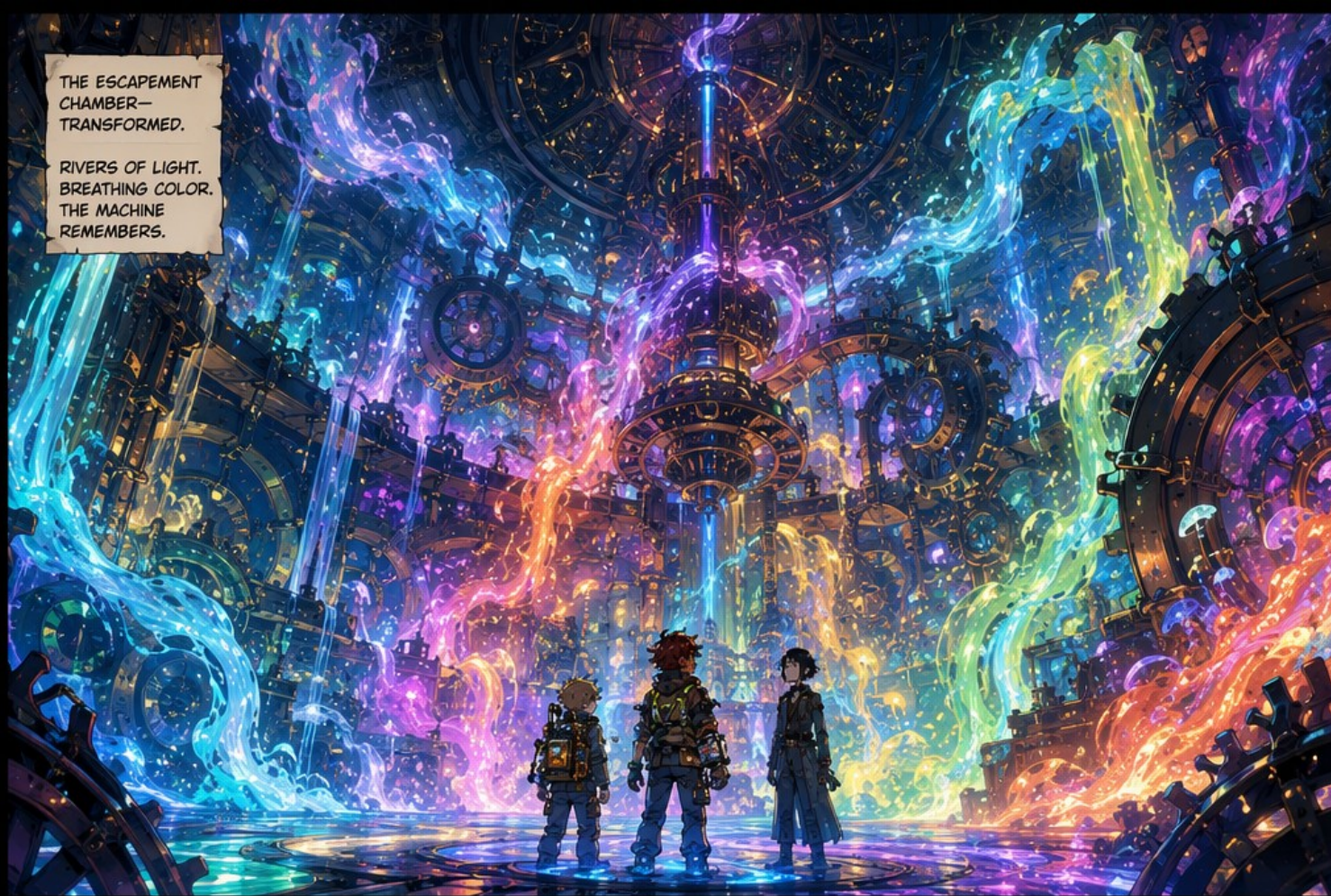
A GEYSER OF RAW
CREATIVE LIGHT
AND COLOR.

RIVERS OF CERULEAN,
GOLD, AND VIOLET
FLOOD THE CHAMBER.

IT'S NOT JUST LIGHT.
IT'S EVERYTHING
WE NEVER DARED
TO IMAGINE.

THE ESCAPEMENT
CHAMBER—
TRANSFORMED.

RIVERS OF LIGHT.
BREATHING COLOR.
THE MACHINE
REMEMBERS.



IT'S NOT
JUST FIXED,
SLOANE.

IT'S
ALIVE.

IT'S
ALWAYS
BEEN
ALIVE.

WE JUST
FINALLY
LISTENED.

EVERYTHING
I KNEW ABOUT
GEARS WAS
WRONG...

THEY'RE
NOT MADE
TO GRIND.

THEY'RE MADE
TO SING.

WE
DID IT.

THE THREE
OF US.

WE
DID IT.

AGAINST
EVERYTHING.





THERE.

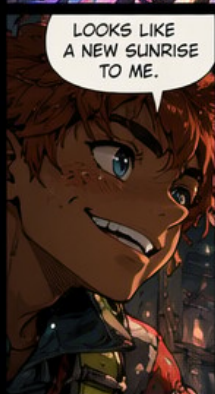


THE SPINDLE
DOESN'T JUST
CONNECT.

IT REMEMBERS.

EVERY DREAM.
EVERY SONG.
EVERY COLOR
EVER PAINTED
IN SECRET.

ALL OF IT
RUSHING UP
TO BE BORN.



LOOKS LIKE
A NEW SUNRISE
TO ME.

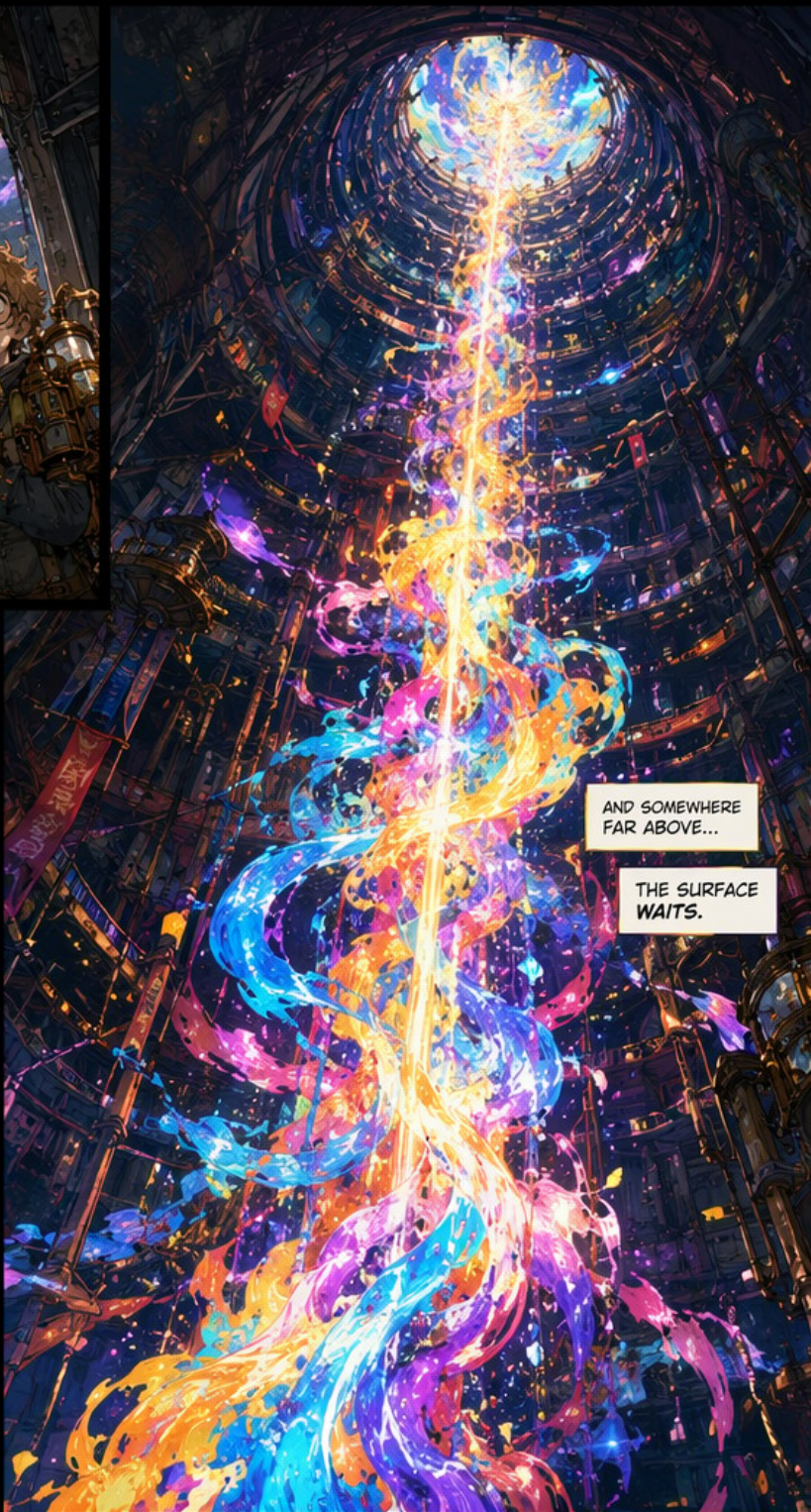


IT'S NOT
A SUNRISE,
RENN.

IT'S A
REMINDER.



I-IT'S...
BEAUTIFUL.



AND SOMEWHERE
FAR ABOVE...

THE SURFACE
WAITS.



THEN LET'S
GIVE 'EM
SOMETHING
WORTH THE
WAIT.

Y-YEAH...

LET'S.

TO BE CONTINUED.
THE SURFACE IS CALLING.

THE ESCAPEMENT.
NO LONGER A PRISON.
SOMETHING ELSE.

IT'S...

IT'S QUIET.

YEAH.

IT STOPPED
SCREAMING.
I GUESS...

IT TRUSTS US
NOW.

HMMNNNN

OR MAYBE
WE FINALLY
LISTENED.

I... I THINK
IT LIKES THE
SONG WE
MADE.

WHATEVER
IT IS NOW...

IT'S
OURS.

WE DIDN'T BREAK
THE ESCAPEMENT.

WE BECAME PART
OF ITS RHYTHM.

NOT HEROES.
NOT SAVIORS.

JUST THREE KIDS
WHO KEPT CLIMBING.

THE ESCAPEMENT
WILL KEEP TURNING.

AND SO WILL WE.

TO BE
CONTINUED...



THE CLOCK IS
NO LONGER
OUR ENEMY.

IT'S OUR
HOME.